ngspice-46 — Full Change Report

Every modification and its reason (original → current)

Ngspice + OpenVAF Enhancements project

July 2026

Contents

ngspice-46 — Full Change Report

Every modification applied to ngspice-46 in this project, with its reason. The baseline is the pristine ngspice-46 source tree (as vendored in the project's `original/` snapshot, which already contains OpenVAF-Reloaded's stock OSDI support); the current state is the tree committed in this repository under `ngspice-46/`. Each entry links the enhancement write-up in `enhancements_doc/` that carries the full engineering detail and the verifying example suite. The companion document openvaf_changes_full-report.md covers the compiler side.

> Maintenance note: this report is updated whenever an enhancement touches ngspice sources. If you are reading it alongside a newer tree, the per-enhancement index at the end tells you the last change it covers.

Scope summary. One new source file and 41 modified ones carry all the functional changes (~2,000 substantive diff lines). A further ~100 `Makefile.in` files and `config.h.in` differ only because the autotools were regenerated with a current libtool (E-77); they contain no hand-written changes and are not listed individually. Everything below is behavior, interface, or diagnostics.

---

1. The OSDI ABI, version 0.4 → 0.7

`src/osdi/osdi.h` is the authoritative C contract between ngspice and the `.osdi` objects `openvaf-r` produces. The project extended it four times — twice additively (new exported symbols old loaders simply never look up), twice with genuine version bumps (layout changes):

Change	Kind	Enhancement	Why
`OSDI_ABSDELAY_COUNTS` / `OSDI_ABSDELAY_INFOS` exports	Additive symbols	E-1	`absdelay()` needs simulator-side waveform history and synthetic delay-equation rows; the descriptors tell ngspice which nodes/offsets each delay slot uses
`OSDI_LAST_CROSSING_COUNTS` / `OSDI_LAST_CROSSING_INFOS` exports	Additive symbols	E-6	`last_crossing()` needs waveform history and crossing interpolation — same additive pattern as absdelay
`OsdiNode.nodeset` field	ABI 0.5 (node stride change)	E-45	Verilog-A net initializers (`electrical a = 5.0;`) become solver initial-guess nodesets; every node record carries the hint
`num_ac_stim_src` / `ac_stim_sources` / `load_ac_stim` descriptor tail	ABI 0.6 (descriptor grows)	E-51	full `ac_stim()` support: a Verilog-A module can *be* the AC stimulus, so the descriptor must enumerate its AC right-hand-side sources
`load_noise` destination stride 1 → 2 (signed `(flat, react)` power pairs)	ABI 0.7	E-54	correct noise physics: operating-point-dependent factors and `ddt()`-shaped (jω) noise need a complex amplitude per source, `re + jω·im`, so coherent same-named sources (LRM 4.6.4) sum with correct sign and frequency shape

Two additive flag conventions ride on the existing `eval()` interface (not version bumps):

- `EVAL_FLAG_IS_FINAL_STEP` (bit $1 \ll 21$) in the eval *input* flags — `@(final_step)` firing (E-53);
- eval *return* flags for `$finish`/`$stop` requests and `$discontinuity`-driven step rejection (E-55).

Pairing consequence: this ngspice requires OSDI $\geq$ 0.7 and rejects older objects with a clear version message; `.osdi` files from older compilers must be recompiled (E-54).

---

2. The OSDI runtime — `src/osdi/`

`osdiaccept.c` — new file (E-55, E-1, E-6)

The accepted-timepoint hook (`DEVaccept`) OSDI previously lacked. It advances the `absdelay/last_crossing` waveform histories only at *accepted* points (so rejected timesteps don't corrupt the delay lines) and reads the per-attempt latched `$finish`/`$stop` request flags at the one boundary where honoring them is safe. Why: acting on `$stop` mid-Newton-iteration was treated as a step failure and ground the timestep into a rejection loop; `$finish` was ignored outright.

`osdidefs.h` (104 diff lines)

- `OsdiExtraInstData` grows the per-instance fields behind every runtime feature: `dt`/`temp` offsets with given-flags (instance temperature), `eval_flags`, absdelay waveform-history rows and pre-allocated KLU/SPARSE matrix-pointer sets for the delay-equation rows (re-pointed on every DC↔AC transition, mirroring the regular Jacobian handling), and the last_crossing history (E-1, E-6, E-55).
- `ALIGN` macro renamed `OSDI_ALIGN`: the macOS SDK's `<sys/param.h>` defines an unrelated `ALIGN`, producing a redefinition warning in every OSDI translation unit (E-77).

`osdiitf.h` / **`osdiext.h`**

The registry-entry structure gains the absdelay/last_crossing descriptor pointers, and `OSDIpendingRequests()` is exported so the analyses can ask "did any device request `$finish`/`$stop` at this accepted point?" (E-1, E-6, E-55).

`osdiregistry.c` (68 diff lines)

- Loads the absdelay/last_crossing descriptor arrays from each `.osdi` and threads them into the registry entries (E-1, E-6).
- Requires OSDI $\geq$ 0.7 (E-54).

`osdiinit.c` (8 diff lines)

- Registers the `DEVaccept` hook (E-55).
- Publishes the synthetic instance-temperature parameter under both spellings, `dt` and the conventional `dtemp` every built-in device uses; `n1 a b mod dtemp=10` used to fail with *"unknown parameter"* while the underlying plumbing was exact (E-80).

`osdiload.c` (441 diff lines — the largest OSDI change)

- Stamps the absdelay synthetic rows (`y_synth`, `z`) for DC, AC and transient, driving the delay from the recorded history (E-1).
- Evaluates `last_crossing` from the recorded waveform with linear interpolation between the bracketing timepoints (E-6).
- Passes the final-step flag through to `eval()` (E-53).
- Latches eval-return flags per timepoint attempt (`point_eval_flags`, OR-ed across Newton iterations, reset per attempt) so `$finish`/`$stop` under solution-dependent conditions survive to the accepted-point boundary (E-55).

- Folds the stride-2 signed noise-power pairs (`fac·|fac|` semantics) when transferring `load_noise` results (E-54, E-42).

`osdisetup.c` (178 diff lines)

- Creates the synthetic delay-equation unknowns and matrix entries for absdelay (E-1).
- Applies the OSDI nodesets (`OsdiNode.nodeset`) as solver initial guesses (E-45).
- A `$fatal`/`$finish` raised during setup (models rejecting their configuration by design — HiSIM's `$port_connected` guards) used to surface as ngspice's baffling *"impossible error — can't occur"*; it now reads *"a Verilog-A device rejected its configuration during setup"* (E-56).
- An internal OSDI node that appears in no Jacobian entry — a net structurally decoupled from the matrix, e.g. an explicit `ground gnd` reference whose branch contribution `V(p,gnd) <+ …` drops the `gnd` column — used to be allocated its own solver row. That all-zero row/column is benign under Sparse (it decouples to `V=0`) but makes the KLU matrix structurally singular, so KLU returned a wrong DC answer (`groundcontrib`: `v(p)=0` not `1.5`; `hierbranch`: branch currents `0`). Such nodes are now tied to ground (node 0) at setup, matching how OpenVAF already treats them and fixing both solvers (E-116).

`osdiacld.c` (89 diff lines)

- AC loading gains the `ac_stim` right-hand-side injection: the partitioned AC-stimulus source array is loaded through `load_ac_stim` and added to the AC RHS with exact magnitude and phase, `$mfactor` applied linearly (deterministic signals scale with multiplicity) (E-51, E-26).
- Complex (jω-shaped) noise coupling entries participate in the AC matrix (E-54).

`osdinoise.c` (93 diff lines)

- Per-instance grouping of same-named noise sources: coherent summation of complex amplitudes `(a + jω·b)·T` before squaring, per LRM 4.6.4 — same-named sources correlate (including exact anti-phase cancellation), differently-named ones stay independent (E-42).
- Reads the stride-2 signed pairs of ABI 0.7 (E-54).

`osditrunc.c` (34 diff lines)

- Honors `$discontinuity(n)`'s next-step clamp: a negative `bound_step` sentinel from the model limits the step after the event (E-24).
- Honors the step-rejection return flag: when an event fired inside the step, `OSDItrunc` requests `delta/8` (with a `20·CKTdelmin` termination floor) so the integrator bisects onto the discontinuity instead of extrapolating across it (E-55).

`osdi/Makefile.am`

Adds `osdiaccept.c` to the build (E-55).

---

3. Analyses — `src/spicelib/analysis/`

`dctran.c` (46 diff lines)

- Advances OSDI delay/crossing histories via the accept path and skips history corruption on rejected steps (E-1, E-6).
- Issues the dedicated `@(final_step)` evaluation at the converged end of a successful transient (E-53).

- Honors accepted-point `$finish` (ends the analysis cleanly, firing `final_step` at the requesting point), `$stop` (pauses resumably), and aborts with a clear error on `$fatal`'s `E_PANIC` instead of retrying it as nonconvergence (E-55).

`dcop.c` (9) and **`acan.c`** (10)

- Fire `@(final_step)` at their successful end (an operating point fires both step events — a single point is first *and* last) (E-53).
- An AC job's operating-point phase carries the analysis name bit (only the name — adding the reactive `CALC_*` bits would wrongly enable integration at an op), so `analysis("ac")` holds through the whole AC run per LRM 4.6.1 and `@(initial_step("ac"))` fires in AC (E-53).

`dctrcurv.c` (150) + **`include/ngspice/trcvdefs.h`** (13)

- Generic **`.dc @inst[param]`** sweeps (a new sweep code): the DC sweep previously hardcoded Vsource/Isource/Resistor/temperature, so sweeping any other device parameter was a fatal error. The generic sweep resolves `@inst[param]` through the device's own parameter tables, refreshes per point via `DEVtemperature` (for OSDI exactly the `alter` path), nests with other sweep variables, and restores the original value afterwards (E-62).
- Fires `final_step` at the last sweep point; honors a `$finish` raised mid-sweep (E-53, E-55).

`noisean.c` (37)

- A singular AC matrix during noise analysis crashed ngspice with a SIGABRT: the code ignored `NIacIter`'s return and the adjoint solve asserted on the unfactored matrix. It now aborts cleanly ("AC solution failed at … Hz") (E-56).
- Honors deferred `$finish`/`$stop` raised at the noise operating point and fires `final_step` on success (E-55, E-53).

`span.c` (31) + **`cktspdum.c`** (14)

- 1-port S-parameter analyses enabled: the "we need at least two ports" error was over-strict (a 1-port is a plain reflection measurement; the matrix machinery is N-general) — and it was hiding the `cadjoint` crash fixed in `dense.c` (E-64).
- **`Rbase`** published into the sp plot from port 1's `z0`, making the Touchstone writers work with no manual `let Rbase = 50` incantation (E-64).
- Stock NaN fixed in **`donoise`** noise-parameter extraction: the uncorrelated noise conductance `Gu` is analytically zero for fully-correlated single-source topologies, and floating-point rounding could land `sqrt(Ycor² + Gu/Rn)`'s argument at $-10^{-18} \to$ NaN for the noise figure. Clamped to the physical range ≥ 0 — found by parity testing against an OSDI resistor that produced the exact textbook NF where the built-in returned NaN (E-63).

`cktdisto.c` (16)

- `.disto` silently reported zero distortion for OSDI devices — the distortion kernel needs higher-order Taylor coefficients the OSDI ABI cannot provide (first derivatives only), and such devices were skipped without a word. A prominent warning now names each affected OSDI device type (E-62).

---

4. Frontend — `src/frontend/`

`plotting/pyplot.c` (new) + **`com_pyplot.c`** (new) + **`plotit.c`**, **`commands.c`** (E-94)

A new interactive command, **`pyplot`**, plots simulated vectors with matplotlib — a Python counterpart to `gnuplot`. `ft_pyplot()` (`plotting/pyplot.c`) mirrors `ft_gnuplot()`: it writes a `<file>.data` table and a `<file>.py` matplotlib script and `system()`s `python3` (synchronously for a PNG, backgrounded for an interactive window). A new `"pyplot"` device arm in `plotit()` routes to it, so it accepts the same plot expressions as `plot`/`gnuplot`; the `com_pyplot()` wrapper mirrors `com_gnuplot()`, and `pyplot` is registered in both command tables. Two `set` variables tune it: `pyplot_terminal=png` renders headless (Agg) to a PNG, and `pyplot_python` picks the interpreter (default `python3`). Purely additive (E-94). The output file base name is optional (E-95): `com_pyplot()` treats the first word as a file name only when it is not a plot expression (no `(`, and not a vector by `vec_get()`), otherwise it defaults to `pyplot` — so `pyplot v(out)` plots directly (the command's minimum argument count was lowered from 2 to 1). `ft_pyplot()` also grew stacked subplots (`set pyplot_subplots=N` → `plt.subplots(nrows, 1, sharex=True)`, `N` traces per panel; `vs` stays the x-axis, so it is not a panel separator) and matplotlib style sheets (`set pyplot_style=<name>`, `dark` → `dark_background`, guarded) (E-98). The headless `pyplot_terminal` was extended from PNG-only to the vector export formats `svg` and `pdf` (`set pyplot_terminal=svg/pdf` → `fig.savefig(<file>.<fmt>)`, matplotlib picking the writer from the extension), and a figure size control was added (`set pyplot_figsize="W,H"` → `plt.subplots(..., figsize=(W, H))`; quote the value so ngspice keeps the comma) (E-99).

`postcoms.c` (414 diff lines) + **`postcoms.h`** + **`commands.c`** (16)

The Touchstone I/O subsystem (E-64, E-72):

- **`wrsnp`** (with `wrs2p` dispatching to the same handler): Touchstone v1 for any port count — the classic 2-port `S11 S21 S12 S22` column order preserved byte-identically, N $\geq$ 3 in the spec's row-major layout with at most four complex pairs per line;
- writer options `wrsnp <file> [ri|ma|db] [s|y|z] [hz|khz|mhz|ghz]`, any combination in any order: MA/DB formats, Y/Z parameters (normalized to Rbase, `Y·R` / `Z/R`, per the v1 spec), frequency units — the option line reflects every choice;
- **`rdsnp`**: reads any Touchstone v1 file into a new plot with a Hz `frequency` scale and complex vectors matching the `.sp` plot's conventions (MA/DB converted back, Y/Z de-normalized, the 2-port column order handled, `Rbase` published so imports round-trip) — measured data diffs against simulation in one `let` expression.

Why: E-63 showed the S-parameter *analysis* was exact but its results could not leave ngspice in the industry-standard format (`wrs2p` demanded a never-created `Rbase` vector), and nothing could bring VNA data in.

`outitf.c` (16)

- Integer operating-point variables recorded per point: `getSpecial` masked with `IF_REAL` only, so an integer opvar saved with `.save @n1[flag]` produced garbage in transient vectors (E-32).
- The plot-memory guard's message printed `%Id` — a Windows-only printf length modifier that is undefined behavior elsewhere and rendered the message as the numberless `"memory required (Id Bytes)"`. Now `%zu`: real byte counts on every platform (E-77).

`resource.c` (27)

`ft_ckspace()` — the *"approaching max data size"* warning (RSS > 95% of RSS + free RAM) — now honors **`set no_mem_check`** (the same opt-out the fatal output-size estimate in `outitf.c` respects; one variable governs both memory guards) and warns once per excursion above the threshold, re-arming below 90%, instead of repeating on every check through a long analysis (E-81).

`display.c` (1)

`#undef NODEV` before the local macro definition — the macOS SDK's `<sys/param.h>` defines an unrelated `NODEV` (E-77).

---

5. Parser and device registry — `src/spicelib/`

`parser/inpgtok.c` (10)

A **`.model`** card override silently dropped its first parameter when the type name and the opening parenthesis had no space between them (`modname devtype(p1=v1 …)`): `INPgetNetTok`'s scan did not treat `(` as a token boundary, so the type token swallowed the paren and the first parameter name. Found while verifying event-function counters whose model-card overrides mysteriously kept defaults (E-8).

`parser/inpgmod.c` (5)

`find_model_parameter()` dereferenced `*(device->numModelParms)`, which is NULL for built-ins that take no model cards (VCVS, CCCS, …) — any *referenced* `.model m vcvs()` card segfaulted, with no OSDI involved at all (an ordinary MOS instance sufficed). This was the true root of the long-documented "module named like a built-in crashes" gotcha. One NULL guard; both shapes now produce clean, located errors (E-76).

`devices/dev.c` (51)

- Duplicate device-type registration warned and skipped: `osdi_add_device()` appended every descriptor unconditionally, and the model-card lookup scans front-to-back — so a module name duplicated across two loaded libraries silently resolved to the *first* registration (loading an updated model library gave the stale device with no hint), and a module named like a built-in corrupted model creation. Registration now checks the table case-insensitively and skips duplicates loudly (E-76).
- **`pre_osdi`** path dedup: loading an already-loaded file notes it and skips — with the remedy stated: *"restart ngspice to load a recompiled file"* (E-76, E-81).

`osdi/osdiparam.c` (E-93)

Setting a fixed (**`localparam`**) OSDI parameter from the netlist used to be swallowed silently: openvaf exports every `localparam` as a parameter, its "given" flag is forced false, and the written value is overwritten by the parameter-init default — so `.model … N=8` on a frozen structural width parameter changed nothing, with no feedback. `OSDIparam`/`OSDImParam` now test the new `PARA_FLAG_FIXED` descriptor flag (set by openvaf, a free bit of the parameter `flags` field) and emit *"parameter 'N' is a fixed (localparam) value and cannot be set from the netlist; ignored"* instead of silently dropping it (E-93).

---

6. Maths — `src/maths/`

`dense/dense.c` (11 substantive lines; the file also carries a whitespace/line-ending normalization from editing)

`cadjoint()` had no 1×1 base case: its cofactor loop allocated 0×0 and then negative-sized minors, killing ngspice with `malloc: can't allocate -8 bytes` — the crash that had been hiding behind the "at least two ports" guard in `span.c`. The adjugate of `[a]` is `[1]` (the empty minor's determinant is 1 by convention), making `cinverse` of a 1×1 equal `1/a`; a 100 Ω load on a 50 Ω port now writes a proper `.s1p` with S11 = 1/3 exactly (E-64).

`sparse/spfactor.c` (6)

The Markowitz-product overflow guards compare a `double` against `LARGEST_LONG_INTEGER` (= `LONG_MAX`), which is not exactly representable as a double; the conversion is now explicit — identical semantics, intentional and warning-free (E-77).

`KLU/klu_multiply.c` (16)

`SMPmultiply`'s KLU path passed `NULL` internal↔external ordering maps to `KLU_matrix_vector_multiply`, which dereferenced them unconditionally (`&NULL[n] = 0x14` for `n = 5`) and segfaulted — so `.option linesearch` crashed under `.option klu`. The line search is the only caller of `SMPmultiply` under KLU, so this path had never been exercised. A NULL map now means the identity ordering (`ext = i + 1`, since the KLU CSR is 0-based and the RHS/Solution vectors are 1-based), making the KLU matrix-vector product — and hence the E-111 line-search residual merit — correct under KLU, with a merit sequence numerically identical to Sparse 1.3 (E-112).

`KLU/klusmp.c` (SMPcaSolve)

`SMPcaSolve` is the complex adjoint (transposed) solve used by noise and S-parameters. Its Sparse branch calls `spSolveTransposed`, but the KLU branch called the *non-transposed* `klu_z_solve` — silently wrong for any asymmetric matrix (every circuit with a transistor or controlled source), which is why `.noise` was disabled under KLU. It now calls `klu_z_tsolve` (transposed), so KLU noise matches Sparse exactly (including OSDI device models). This is the core of E-113, which also removes the KLU refusal guards in `noisean.c` / `pzan.c` (single-ended pole-zero runs under KLU; balanced-output pole-zero keeps a targeted guard).

`spicelib/analysis/cktsens.c`

Sensitivity builds an auxiliary perturbation matrix `delta_Y` (holding $\partial Y/\partial p$) via `SMPnewMatrix`, which allocates a plain Sparse 1.3 matrix (`delta_Y->CKTkluMODE = 0`, no `SMPkluMatrix`). It is only *multiplied* against the solution (`SMPmultiply` → `spMultiply`), never factored, and `DEVbindCSC` always binds into `ckt->CKTmatrix`, not `delta_Y` — so it is correctly Sparse in every case. But two KLU-only setup blocks were gated on the main matrix's `CKTkluMODE`, so under `.option klu` they ran and dereferenced the NULL `delta_Y->SMPkluMatrix` — a segfault on every DC/AC `.sens` deck. The blocks now gate on `delta_Y->CKTkluMODE` (its own flag, `0`), keeping `delta_Y` Sparse under KLU exactly as it already is under the default solver, while the main `Y` matrix stays KLU. DC and AC sensitivity now match Sparse exactly (E-114).

`spicelib/analysis/distoan.c`

Distortion is a complex analysis (Volterra series solved at the harmonic / intermodulation frequencies via `NIdIter` → `SMPcSolve`), but `distoan.c` had no KLU code at all: under `.option klu` the KLU matrix stayed in *real* mode, the complex solves ran against an unconverted matrix, and every harmonic came back zero — a silent wrong answer. The fix mirrors `acan.c`: before the solve loop it converts the matrix to complex (`DEVbindCSCComplex` per device + `KLUmatrixIsComplex`), and on exit converts back to real (`DEVbindCSCComplexToReal`) so a later real analysis in the same session is unaffected. KLU distortion now matches Sparse bit-for-bit (single-tone, two-tone intermodulation, and OSDI models) (E-115).

---

7. Build system

`xspice/icm/makedefs.in` (4)

The XSPICE codemodel (`.cm`) link rule hardcoded the pre-macOS-10.3 idiom `-bundle -flat_namespace -undefined suppress`, deprecated loudly by the modern linker on all 14 codemodel links (CI macOS builds included). Now `-bundle -undefined dynamic_lookup` — the modern spelling for plugins whose host symbols resolve at load time (E-77).

Autotools regeneration (the ~100 **`Makefile.in`** files + **`config.h.in`**)

Regenerated by `./autogen.sh` with libtool 2.5.4 during the zero-warning work — a build tree whose `configure` predates libtool 2.4.7 selects the deprecated darwin `-undefined suppress` flag whenever `MACOSX_DEPLOYMENT_TARGET` is unset. No hand-written content (E-77).

---

8. Per-enhancement index

Every enhancement that touched ngspice, oldest first:

Enhancement	ngspice files	One line
E-1	osdi.h, osdidefs.h, osdiitf.h, osdiregistry.c, osdiload.c, osdisetup.c, dctran.c (+accept path)	`absdelay()`: synthetic delay rows + waveform history
E-6	osdi.h, osdidefs.h, osdiitf.h, osdiregistry.c, osdiload.c	`last_crossing()`: history + interpolated crossings
E-8	parser/inpgtok.c	`.model` card first-parameter drop fix
E-24	osditrunc.c	`$discontinuity` next-step clamp
E-25	osdi callbacks (get_simparams)	expose `analysis_name` + `simulator` simparams
E-32	outitf.c	integer opvars recorded per point
E-42	osdinoise.c	coherent same-named noise grouping (LRM 4.6.4)
E-45	osdi.h (ABI 0.5), osdisetup.c	Verilog-A nodesets applied to the solver
E-51	osdi.h (ABI 0.6), osdiacld.c	full `ac_stim` AC-RHS injection
E-53	dctran.c, dcop.c, dctrcurv.c, acan.c, noisean.c, osdiload.c	`@(final_step)` + analysis-name phase bits
E-54	osdi.h (ABI 0.7), osdinoise.c, osdiload.c, osdiacld.c, osdiregistry.c	node-free complex noise factors, stride-2 pairs
E-55	osdiaccept.c (new), osdiload.c, osditrunc.c, osdiinit.c, dctran.c, dctrcurv.c, osdiitf.h, Makefile.am	`$finish`/`$stop`/`$fatal` honored; `$discontinuity` step rejection
E-56	noisean.c, osdisetup.c	noise SIGABRT fix; setup-rejection diagnostics
E-62	dctrcurv.c, trcvdefs.h, cktdisto.c	generic `.dc @inst[param]` sweeps; `.disto` warning
E-63	span.c	`donoise` NaN clamp (stock defect, found by parity)
E-64	span.c, cktspdum.c, dense.c, postcoms.c/.h, commands.c	Touchstone export, auto-`Rbase`, 1-port `.sp`, `cadjoint` 1×1
E-72	postcoms.c/.h, commands.c	Touchstone round 2: MA/DB/Y/Z/units + `rdsnp` reader
E-76	dev.c, inpgmod.c	duplicate-registration warning, load dedup, stock `.model` segfault fix

Enhancement	ngspice files	One line
E-77	osdidefs.h, display.c, outitf.c, spfactor.c, makedefs.in (+autotools regen)	zero-warning build, 33 → 0
E-80	osdiinit.c	`dtemp` instance-parameter alias
E-81	resource.c, dev.c	memory-warning opt-out + once-per-excursion; reload-note hint
E-93	osdi.h, osdiparam.c	warn (not silently ignore) when a netlist sets a `PARA_FLAG_FIXED` (`localparam`) OSDI parameter
E-94	plotting/pyplot.c (new), com_pyplot.c (new), plotit.c, commands.c	new `pyplot` command — plot vectors with matplotlib (a Python `gnuplot`)
E-95	com_pyplot.c, commands.c	make the `pyplot` output file name optional (defaults to `pyplot`)
E-98	plotting/pyplot.c	`pyplot` stacked subplots (`pyplot_subplots=N`) + matplotlib style sheets (`pyplot_style`)
E-99	plotting/pyplot.c	`pyplot` vector export formats (`pyplot_terminal=svg/pdf`) + figure size (`pyplot_figsize`)
E-110	optdefs.h, tskdefs.h, cktsopt.c, cktntask.c	`.option errpreset=conservative|moderate|liberal` — one knob for a coordinated tolerance/robustness set; explicit options override regardless of order (`moderate` = historical defaults)
E-111	optdefs.h, tskdefs.h, cktdefs.h, cktsopt.c, cktdojob.c, cktntask.c, cktdest.c, niiter.c	`.option linesearch` — globalized (damped) Newton via Armijo backtracking on a new KCL-residual merit $\|F\| = \|G \cdot x - b\|$; result-neutral, off by default
E-112	maths/KLU/klu_multiply.c	KLU support for `.option linesearch` — `SMPmultiply`'s KLU path passed NULL ordering maps that `klu_matrix_vector_multiply` dereferenced (SIGSEGV); NULL now means identity ordering. Line search verified merit-identical KLU vs Sparse
E-113	maths/KLU/klusmp.c, spicelib/analysis/noisean.c, pzan.c	KLU support for noise + single-ended pole-zero — `SMPcaSolve`'s adjoint KLU branch used the non-transposed solve (silently wrong noise on asymmetric matrices); now `klu_z_tsolve`. Guards removed; balanced-output pz keeps a targeted guard
E-114	spicelib/analysis/cktsens.c	KLU support for sensitivity — the auxiliary perturbation matrix `delta_Y` is Sparse, but two KLU setup blocks gated on the *main* matrix's flag dereferenced its NULL `SMPkluMatrix` (segfault on every DC/AC `.sens`); now gated on `delta_Y`'s own flag. DC/AC `.sens` match Sparse exactly
E-115	spicelib/analysis/distoan.c	KLU support for distortion — `.disto` is a complex analysis but `distoan.c` had no KLU code, so under KLU the matrix stayed real and every harmonic came back zero (silent wrong answer); now converts real↔complex around the solve loop like `acan.c`. Matches Sparse bit-for-bit

Enhancement	ngspice files	One line
E-116	osdi/osdisetup.c	KLU wrong-DC fix — an OSDI internal node with no Jacobian entry (a decoupled `ground` reference) was given an all-zero solver row that made the KLU matrix structurally singular; now tied to ground. Fixes the `groundcontrib` and `hierbranch` KLU_XFAILs
E-117	configure.ac (`+configure`), spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	Periodic steady state (PSS) productionized — built by default (was experimental `--enable-pss`, so `.pss` was unimplemented in shipped builds); ~230 lines of shooting-loop trace routed through `set ngdebug` (232 → 31 lines by default); fail-fast KLU guard (PSS hangs under KLU) directing `.pss` to `.option sparse`
E-118	spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	PSS runs under KLU — the shooting loop hung under KLU (`klu_refactor`'s reused pivots inflated the truncation error into a ~20M-step timestep explosion); forcing a full re-factor (`NISHOULDREORDER`) each PSS step makes KLU converge to the same result as Sparse. E-117's Sparse-only guard removed
E-119	pssdefs.h, spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	Retain the PSS periodic operating point — PSS sampled the node voltages per period for its DFT then freed them, and never captured device states; now the voltages and `CKTstate0` states are captured per sample and retained on the `PSSan` job (with frequency + dims) as the substrate for the periodic small-signal suite (PAC/pnoise/PXF). Self-checks that the retained samples reproduce the fundamental
E-120	spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	Periodic small-signal Jacobian harmonics — walk the retained operating point, re-linearize each sample (`CKTload` MODEINITSMSIG) and stamp `G+jC` (`CKTacLoad` ω=1), read the osc-node diagonal → `g(t)`, `c(t)`, DFT to harmonics. The blocks the PAC conversion matrix is built from. (Fixed a complex-mode-not-set bug where `C(t)` accumulated across samples.) Verified: RC gives `G=1/R1`, `C=C1`, no harmonics
E-121	spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	PAC conversion-matrix engine — extend E-120 from the osc diagonal to every matrix nonzero, complex-DFT to harmonics `G_k`, `C_k`, assemble the `(2M+1)N` harmonic conversion matrix `H_{nm}=G_{n−m}+jω_m·C_{n−m}`, inject a unit current at the osc node in sideband 0 and solve by dense complex LU (`pss_csolve`), report the sideband conversion gains. The numerical heart of PAC/pnoise/PXF. Verified: linear RC gives sideband-0 = AC driving-point ‘

Enhancement	ngspice files	One line
E-122	include/ngspice/pssdefs.h, spicelib/analysis/psssetp.c, spicelib/parser/inp2dot.c, spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	`.pac` command (periodic AC) — the user-facing analysis on the E-121 engine. `.pac Fguess StabTime OscNode Points Harmonics SC_iter Steady_coeff <dec|oct|lin> Npts Fstart Fstop` runs PSS then sweeps the input frequency, solving the conversion matrix at each point and emitting the 0-th-sideband node responses as a complex `PAC Analysis` plot (`print`/`plot`/`wrdata`). Reuses the PSS analysis via a `PSSdoPAC` flag; engine factored into `pac_extract_harmonics` (once) + `pac_solve_at` (per freq). Verified: swept sideband-0 `|b(f)|` == analytic AC driving-point `|Z(f)|` to 1.6e−7 across 10 kHz–1 MHz
E-123	include/ngspice/pssdefs.h, spicelib/analysis/psssetp.c, spicelib/parser/inp2dot.c, spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	finish `.pac` — (1) source-referenced stimulus: capture the netlist AC-source RHS from `CKTacLoad` as the sideband-0 stimulus `B_0` (a periodic-AC transfer/conversion gain), unit-current-at-osc-node fallback; (2) multi-sideband output: optional trailing `maxsideband Ksb` emits every conversion sideband `f_in+k·f0` (`k=−Ksb..Ksb`) as its own vector — sideband 0 keeps the node name, others `<node>_usb<k>`/`<node>_lsb<k>` via `IFnewUid`. Verified: RC with `V1 AC 1` gives sideband-0 = low-pass transfer `1/√(1+(2πfRC)²)` (0.998→0.157) with `b_usb1`/`b_lsb1` ~0 (no conversion)
E-124	include/ngspice/pssdefs.h, spicelib/analysis/psssetp.c, spicelib/parser/inp2dot.c, spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	`.pnoise` command (periodic noise) — fold each device's noise through the conversion matrix. `pac_solve_adjoint` solves `Hᵀ Ψ = e_{out,0}`; `pnoise_sweep` loads the sideband-k adjoint into `CKTrhs`/`CKTirhs` and calls the existing device noise routines (`NevalSrc`, OSDI `load_noise`) once per sideband, accumulating `Σ_k S·|ΔΨ_k|²` — reuses every device noise model via a minimal local `NOISEAN` context. `.pnoise <pss> OutNode InSrc <dec|oct|lin> Np Fstart Fstop`; emits `onoise_spectrum`/`inoise_spectrum`. Verified: linear RC reduces exactly to `.noise` (`4kTR/(1+(2πfRC)²)`, matches the `.noise` reference to every digit)
E-125	include/ngspice/pssdefs.h, spicelib/analysis/psssetp.c, spicelib/parser/inp2dot.c, spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	`.pxf` command (periodic transfer function) — the adjoint of PAC, completing the PSS→PAC→Pnoise→PXF suite. `pxf_sweep` solves `Hᵀ Ψ = e_{out,0}` per frequency and dots each sideband block with the AC-source pattern `B0` → `xf_k=Σ_j Ψ_k(j)·B0(j)`, the input→output transfer at each sideband. `.pxf <pss> OutNode <dec|oct|lin> Np Fstart Fstop [maxsb]`; emits `xf` + `xf_usb<k>`/`xf_lsb<k>`. Verified: by the identity `(H⁻¹B)_out=(H⁻ᵀe_out)ᵀB` the sideband-0 transfer is bit-identical to the PAC response (0.998→0.157 low-pass), conversion sidebands ~2e−16

Enhancement	ngspice files	One line
E-126	include/ngspice/pssdefs.h, spicelib/analysis/psssetp.c, spicelib/parser/inp2dot.c, spicelib/analysis/dcpss.c	cyclostationary noise — `.pnoise ... cyclo` evaluates each device's noise PSD `S(t)` at every PSS sample's bias (`CKTload` per sample) and folds it through the time-domain adjoint transfer `A_s(j)=Σ_k Ψ_k(j)e^{j2πks/P}`, averaging: `onoise(f)=(1/P)Σ_s S(t_s)·|ΔA_s|²`. Reuses the device noise routines. Verified: (1) reduces exactly to `.noise` on the linear RC (bias-independent thermal → Parseval); (2) a flicker resistor carrying the RC current gives `onoise·f = R1²·KF·⟨I²⟩ = 4.88e−10` (uses the period-average `⟨I²⟩`, matched to 5 digits)
E-127	include/ngspice/{optdefs,tskdefs,ckpdefs,ckt}.h, spicelib/analysis/{cktsopt,cktntask,cktdojob,cktop,cktacct}.c, maths/ni/niiter.c	pseudo-transient continuation — `.option ptcont` solves `f(x)=0` by backward-Euler pseudo-transient `f(x)+Gps·(x−x_prev)=0` and marches `dτ` small→large (`Gps`→`0`). `Gps` diagonal via the gmin path; the `Gps·x_prev` RHS coupling (added in `NIiter`) makes each step a stable-trajectory move, not a static gmin step. New `pseudo_transient` in the `CKTop` cascade, off by default. Verified under KLU+Sparse: result-neutral on normal circuits; on a stiff no-limiting exp, reaches the correct DC `0.837922 V` where plain Newton lands on a spurious `70.5 V` (21/21)

(E-25's simparam exposure lives in the OSDI callback table populated at load time; its diff rides inside the `osdiload.c`/callbacks changes.)

Every entry above is guarded by a verify script under `examples/` and was regression-checked against the full example arsenal, the compiler's integration suite, and the VA_TEST industry-model corpus at the time it landed.